

Americium

95
Am

Scientists decided to name americium after North America, where it was first made. Some smoke detectors use tiny amounts of this element, as its radioactivity allows an electric current to pass through the air between two sensors in the device. Any smoke blocking the current causes the detector to sound an alarm.

ATOMIC MASS (243)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1944 (team led by Glenn T Seaborg)

Berkelium

97
Bk

The first particle accelerators were built in the University of California, in the town of Berkeley, USA. It was here that this metal was first created, so it was named after the town. Scientists made berkelium by smashing atoms of helium and americium together. This element is used only to make even heavier elements.

ATOMIC MASS (247)

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1949 (team led by Glenn T Seaborg)

